KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

Instructions for the Man of the House

Every instruction in Scripture that falls on a married father

A Kingdom Life Teaching Handout for husbands and fathers who do not farm or raise livestock

Scripture quoted from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai, with Yahshua and Messiah restored. Torah is referred to throughout as the instructions of YHWH.

THE HEART OF IT

Most men have never been shown what Scripture actually asks of them. They have heard about rules, or they have heard that the rules are gone. Very few have opened the instructions and asked a simple question: **which of these are mine to walk in, right where I live?**

This handout gathers them in one place for a married man with children who works a regular job and does not farm or keep livestock. All 103 are numbered and given with their references, so you can open your Bible and check every one.

> *If you love me, keep my commandments.*
> **JOHN 14:15**

SECTION I

How to Read This Handout

Scripture never hands us a numbered list. The famous count of 613 commandments comes from the rabbis (Talmud, Makkot 23b), not from the text itself, so we do not use it here. Instead, every instruction below is tied to the verse it comes from. Where Scripture stops speaking, an interpretation should not be called a commandment, and we hold this handout to that same test.

The Hebrew word *torah* comes from *yarah*, to point, to aim, to teach. It is instruction, the way a father points his son down the right road. That is why we call it the instructions of YHWH. Moses said plainly that this commandment is not too hard for you (**Deuteronomy 30:11**).

The Labels You Will See

- **No label.** A plain instruction that applies to you today.
- **PRINCIPLE**: the letter was given in a setting you may not be in, but the principle carries straight into your life.
- **SITUATIONAL**: applies only when that situation comes up, such as the first year of marriage or a divorce.
- **WISDOM**: from Proverbs. True and binding on the conscience, but written as wisdom rather than as a Torah commandment.

- **DEBATED**: believers who keep the instructions read this one differently. The note tells you why.

> **NOT A LADDER TO HEAVEN**
>
> None of this is how a man earns salvation. Yahshua paid for that with his own blood. These are the instructions of a Father to a son who already belongs to him. **We do not obey to be accepted. We obey because we have been.**

SECTION II

Toward YHWH

Everything starts here. Yahshua called the Shema the first and greatest commandment (**Matthew 22:37-38**). A man cannot lead his house toward an Elohim he does not love himself.

> *Hear, Israel: YHWH is our Elohim. YHWH is one. You shall love YHWH your Elohim with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your might.*
> **DEUTERONOMY 6:4-5**

1. Love YHWH with all your heart, soul and strength. **Deut 6:4-5; Matt 22:37**
2. Fear him, serve him, cling to him, and swear only by his name. **Deut 6:13; 10:20**
3. Have no other gods, and make no idols to bow down to. **Ex 20:3-6**
4. Do not take his name in vain. **Ex 20:7**
5. Do not speak the names of other gods. **Ex 23:13**
6. Do not ask how the nations served their gods so you can worship YHWH the same way. **Deut 12:30-31**
7. Keep idol objects out of your house. **Deut 7:25-26**
8. Do not add to his instructions or take away from them. **Deut 4:2; 12:32**
9. Test every prophet, and reject anyone who leads you toward other gods. **Deut 13:1-5; 18:15-22**
10. No divination, sorcery, omens, mediums or spiritists. **Lev 19:26, 31; 20:6; Deut 18:10-12**
11. Bless YHWH after you eat and are satisfied. **Deut 8:10**

SECTION III

The Sabbath and the Appointed Times

The appointed times are not Israel's holidays. YHWH calls them his own, and he summons his people to them. As the head of the house, a man sets the rhythm his family lives by.

> *The set feasts of YHWH, which you shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even these are my set feasts.*
> **LEVITICUS 23:2**

12. Keep the seventh day holy. Do no work, and do not make your son, your daughter, your workers or the stranger with you work. **Ex 20:8-11; Deut 5:12-15**
13. Do not buy or sell on the Sabbath. **Neh 10:31; 13:15-22; Isa 58:13; Amos 8:5**

14. Keep the appointed times of YHWH. **Lev 23**
15. Passover and Unleavened Bread: put the leaven out of your house and eat unleavened bread. No uncircumcised man eats the Passover. **Ex 12:15-20, 48**
16. Yom Kippur: afflict your soul and do no work. **Lev 23:27-32**
17. Sukkot: live in booths, take the branches, and rejoice with your son and daughter. **Lev 23:40-42; Deut 16:14**
18. The males appear before YHWH three times a year. **Deut 16:16** DEBATED
    The verse says in the place which he chooses. How a man keeps this without a Temple is where believers differ.
19. Hear the instructions read aloud at Sukkot in the seventh year. **Deut 31:10-13** SITUATIONAL

SECTION IV

As a Husband

Paul does not tell husbands to rule their wives. He tells them to love them the way Messiah loves his bride, by laying his life down. Every instruction in this section is an expression of that one.

> *Husbands, love your wives, even as Messiah also loved the assembly, and gave himself up for it;*
> **EPHESIANS 5:25**

20. Love your wife as Messiah loved the assembly, and give yourself for her. **Eph 5:25-33**
21. Do not be bitter toward her. **Col 3:19**
22. Live with her with understanding and give her honor, so your prayers are not hindered. **1 Pet 3:7**
23. Do not hold back her food, her clothing, or her marital rights. **Ex 21:10** PRINCIPLE
    Given in the setting of a man taking another wife. The duty it names toward a wife carries for every husband.
24. Give your wife what you owe her in marriage. Do not deprive each other, except by agreement for a season of prayer. **1 Cor 7:3-5**
25. Rejoice in the wife of your youth. **Prov 5:15-19** WISDOM
26. Do not deal treacherously with her. **Mal 2:14-16**
27. A newly married man stays home one year to make his wife happy. **Deut 24:5** SITUATIONAL
28. No relations during her monthly impurity. **Lev 15:19-24; 18:19; 20:18**
29. After an emission, bathe; you are unclean until evening. **Lev 15:16-18**
30. Keep the marriage bed undefiled. **Heb 13:4**
31. You confirm or cancel your wife's vows on the day you hear them. **Num 30:6-15**
32. If divorce comes, give a written certificate, and do not take her back after she has married another man. **Deut 24:1-4; Matt 19:9** SITUATIONAL

> *You husbands, in the same way, live with your wives according to knowledge, giving honor to the woman, as to the weaker vessel, as being also joint heirs of the grace of life; that your prayers may not be hindered.*
> **1 PETER 3:7**

SAY IT PLAINLY

Peter ties a man's prayer life to how he treats his wife. **If heaven feels shut, check the house first.**

SECTION V

As a Father

In Scripture the father is the first teacher. Not the pastor, not the school. The words go on his heart first, and then he teaches them diligently to his children in the ordinary moments of the day.

> *These words, which I command you today, shall be on your heart; and you shall teach them diligently to your children, and shall talk of them when you sit in your house, and when you walk by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise up.*
> **DEUTERONOMY 6:6-7**

33. Teach your children the instructions diligently, at home, on the road, lying down and rising up. **Deut 6:7; 11:19; 4:9**
34. Tell your son what YHWH did for you at Passover. **Ex 12:26-27; 13:8, 14**
35. Circumcise your sons on the eighth day. **Gen 17:12; Lev 12:3**
36. Redeem your firstborn son. **Ex 13:13; Num 18:15-16** DEBATED
    The five shekels were paid to the priests. With no functioning priesthood, believers differ on how or whether to keep it.
37. Do not provoke your children to wrath; nurture them in the discipline and instruction of Adonai. **Eph 6:4; Col 3:21**
38. Correct your children and train them in the way they should go. **Prov 13:24; 22:6** WISDOM
39. Provide for your own household. A man who does not has denied the faith. **1 Tim 5:8**
40. Do not favor the son of a loved wife over the true firstborn in the inheritance. **Deut 21:15-17** PRINCIPLE
    Written for a man with two wives. The principle stands for any father with children from more than one marriage: no favoritism in what you leave them.
41. You confirm or cancel your daughter's vows while she lives in your house. **Num 30:3-5**
42. Never give your daughter over to prostitution. **Lev 19:29**
43. Never give a child to Molech or pass one through the fire. **Lev 18:21**

> *You fathers, don't provoke your children to wrath, but nurture them in the discipline and instruction of Adonai.*
> **EPHESIANS 6:4**

SECTION VI

As a Son

A father never stops being a son. The fifth commandment is the first with a promise attached (**Ephesians 6:2**), and your children are watching how you keep it.

44. Honor your father and your mother. **Ex 20:12**
45. Revere your mother and your father. **Lev 19:3**
46. Do not curse your father or mother. **Ex 21:17**

SECTION VII

Sexual Purity

Yahshua took adultery from the bed to the eyes. Purity for a married man starts long before any act.

47. Do not commit adultery, including lust in the heart. **Ex 20:14; Matt 5:27-28**
48. Keep the forbidden relations of Leviticus 18 and 20, including not taking your wife's sister while your wife is alive. **Lev 18; 20; Lev 18:18**
49. Flee sexual immorality. **1 Cor 6:18; Acts 15:20**

SECTION VIII

Food

> *For you are a holy people to YHWH your Elohim, and YHWH has chosen you to be a people for his own possession, above all peoples who are on the face of the earth.*
> **DEUTERONOMY 14:2**

YHWH gives the food instructions as part of being set apart. They are obedience first. Health benefits are real, but they are not the reason.

50. Eat only the clean animals. **Lev 11; Deut 14:3-20**
51. Do not eat blood. **Lev 17:10-14; Deut 12:16, 23; Acts 15:20**
52. Do not eat the fat of the ox, the sheep or the goat. **Lev 3:17; 7:23-25**
53. Do not eat what died of itself or was torn by beasts. **Lev 17:15; Deut 14:21**
54. Do not boil a young goat in its mother's milk. **Ex 23:19; Deut 14:21** DEBATED
    Rabbinic tradition turned this into the full separation of meat and dairy. The text itself names a kid and its own mother's milk.
55. Do not get drunk with wine. **Eph 5:18**

SECTION IX

Appearance and Dress

> *and it shall be to you for a fringe, that you may look on it, and remember all YHWH's commandments, and do them;*
> **NUMBERS 15:39**

56. Wear tzitzit on the four corners of your garment, with a cord of blue. **Num 15:37-41; Deut 22:12**
57. Write his words on the doorposts of your house and on your gates. **Deut 6:9; 11:20**
58. Bind them as a sign on your hand and between your eyes. **Deut 6:8** DEBATED
    Some keep this literally. Others read it as what you do (the hand) and how you think (the eyes), as in Proverbs 3:3 and 7:3.
59. Do not round the corners of your head or mar the corners of your beard. **Lev 19:27**
60. No cuttings in your flesh for the dead, and no tattoos. **Lev 19:28**
61. Do not wear wool and linen woven together. **Lev 19:19; Deut 22:11**
62. Do not wear what pertains to a woman. **Deut 22:5**
63. Do not cover your head when you pray. **1 Cor 11:4** DEBATED
    Paul's words in their setting are debated, but this is the plain reading. Note that it runs opposite to the rabbinic head covering.
64. Long hair on a man is a dishonor. **1 Cor 11:14** DEBATED

SECTION X

Work, Money and Business

The instructions do not stop at the door of the shop or the office. How a man earns, lends, pays and sells is part of his walk.

> *You shall do no unrighteousness in judgment, in measures of length, of weight, or of quantity. You shall have just balances, just weights, a just ephah, and a just hin. I am YHWH your Elohim, who brought you out of the land of Egypt.*
> **LEVITICUS 19:35-36**

65. Work six days. **Ex 20:9; 2 Thess 3:10**
66. Use honest weights and measures, and deal honestly in every sale. **Lev 19:35-36; Deut 25:13-16**
67. Pay your workers on time, and do not oppress them. **Lev 19:13; Deut 24:14-15**
68. Charge no interest to a brother in need. **Ex 22:25; Lev 25:35-37; Deut 23:19-20**
69. Return a poor man's pledge by sundown. Never take a millstone as a pledge, or a widow's garment. **Ex 22:26-27; Deut 24:6, 10-13, 17**
70. Open your hand wide to the poor. **Deut 15:7-11**

71. Release debts in the seventh year. **Deut 15:1-2** **DEBATED**
    This is about lending, not farming. Believers differ on whether and how it is kept today.
72. Do not steal or deal falsely. Repay what you took, and add a fifth. **Ex 20:15; Lev 6:1-5; 19:11**
73. Return lost property to its owner. **Deut 22:1-3**
74. Build a railing on your roof, so no one falls from your house. **Deut 22:8** **PRINCIPLE**
    Flat roofs were living space. The principle is a duty to make your home and work safe for others.
75. Pay your taxes, and give honor to whom honor is due. **Matt 22:21; Rom 13:7**
76. Give generously and in secret. **Matt 6:1-4; 2 Cor 9:7**

SECTION XI

Toward Your Neighbor

> *You shall not take vengeance, nor bear any grudge against the children of your people; but you shall love your neighbor as yourself. I am YHWH.*
> **LEVITICUS 19:18**

77. Do not murder, and do not hate your brother in your heart. **Ex 20:13; Lev 19:17; Matt 5:21-22**
78. No false witness, no gossip, no slander. **Ex 20:16; Lev 19:16**
79. Rebuke your neighbor rather than carry sin against him. **Lev 19:17**
80. No vengeance and no grudges. Love your neighbor as yourself. **Lev 19:18**
81. Love the stranger. **Lev 19:33-34; Deut 10:19**
82. Do not curse the deaf or put a stumbling block before the blind. **Lev 19:14**
83. Rise up before the gray head and honor the aged. **Lev 19:32**
84. Do not oppress the widow or the fatherless. **Ex 22:22; James 1:27**
85. Judge fairly. Take no bribe. Do not follow a crowd into evil. **Lev 19:15; Ex 23:1-8**
86. Keep your vows. Let your yes be yes and your no be no. **Num 30:2; Deut 23:21-23; Matt 5:33-37**
87. Do not curse a ruler of your people. **Ex 22:28**
88. Pray for kings and all who are in authority. **1 Tim 2:1-2**

SECTION XII

From Yahshua and the Apostles

Yahshua did not come to destroy the instructions but to fulfill them (**Matthew 5:17**). He and his apostles also spoke directly to how a man walks with him now.

> *For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you don't forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.*
> **MATTHEW 6:14-15**

89. Repent and be immersed. **Acts 2:38**
90. Forgive, or you will not be forgiven. **Matt 6:14-15; 18:21-35; Mark 11:25**
91. Be reconciled to your brother before you bring your gift. **Matt 5:23-24**
92. Love your enemies and pray for those who persecute you. **Matt 5:44**
93. Love one another as he loved you. **John 13:34**
94. Make disciples. **Matt 28:19-20**
95. Remember him in the bread and the cup. **1 Cor 11:23-26**
96. Do not forsake assembling together. **Heb 10:25**
97. Pray without ceasing, lifting holy hands without anger. **1 Thess 5:17; 1 Tim 2:8**
98. Humble yourself. **1 Pet 5:5-6; James 4:6**
99. Put away anger, bitterness and corrupt speech. **Eph 4:26, 29, 31**
100. Do not be unequally yoked with unbelievers. **2 Cor 6:14**
101. Show hospitality. **Heb 13:2**
102. When you are sick, call the elders to pray over you. **James 5:14**
103. If you lead, meet the qualifications of an elder. **1 Tim 3:1-7; Titus 1:5-9; 1 Pet 5:2-3; James 3:1** SITUATIONAL

> **THE ORDER OF THINGS**
>
> **Humility is the root of forgiveness, and forgiveness is the root of deliverance.** A man can keep every line in this handout on the outside and still be bound on the inside. Start with the heart, and the rest follows.

SECTION XIII

What Does Not Fall on You, and Why

Leaving these out does not mean they were abolished. It means they were given to someone else, or they need something that is not in place today.

- **Sacrifices, priesthood, Levites and Temple service**, including the red heifer, the leprosy inspections and the jealousy offering. Each one requires a priest or the Temple. (Lev 1 to 7; 13 to 14; 21 to 22; Num 5; 19)
- **The Nazirite vow.** It only applies if a man chooses to take it. (Num 6)
- **Kings, courts and punishments.** These were given to the government of Israel. (Deut 17)
- **Farming instructions:** the sabbatical and jubilee land rest, gleaning, firstfruits of produce, mixed seed, and the tithe of crops and herds. (Lev 19:9-10; 25; 27:30-32)
- **Livestock instructions:** firstborn animals, mixed breeding, and not muzzling the ox. Paul applies that last one to paying those who teach the Word. (Deut 25:4; 1 Cor 9:9)

> **A NOTE ON THE TITHE**
>
> The Torah tithe was taken from crops and herds, so a man with neither has no Torah tithe of his own. Still, look at how YHWH told it to be used. It could be turned into money and spent rejoicing before him at the feast (**Deuteronomy 14:22-26**), and every third year it went to the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless and the widow (**Deuteronomy 14:28-29**). Giving the first part of your increase for the feasts and the poor walks right in that pattern.

SECTION XIV

Walking It Out This Week

- **Pick one section.** Read it with your wife and ask her where you are strong and where you are not.
- **Gather your children once this week** and teach them one instruction and why YHWH gave it.
- **Make one thing right.** Forgive one specific thing, and ask forgiveness for one specific thing.
- **Check your work life** against Section X: your pay, your prices, your promises.
- **Write down** any instruction you have never walked in, and pray over it before you change anything.

SECTION XV

Cross Reference Index

Framework: John 14:15; Deuteronomy 4:2; 30:11; Matthew 5:17; 22:37-40

Toward YHWH: Exodus 20:3-7; 23:13; Leviticus 19:26, 31; 20:6; Deuteronomy 6:4-5, 13; 7:25-26; 8:10; 10:20; 12:30-32; 13:1-5; 18:10-22

Sabbath and appointed times: Exodus 12:15-20, 48; 20:8-11; Leviticus 23; Deuteronomy 5:12-15; 16:14-16; 31:10-13; Nehemiah 10:31; 13:15-22; Isaiah 58:13; Amos 8:5

Husband: Exodus 21:10; Leviticus 15:16-24; 18:19; 20:18; Numbers 30:6-15; Deuteronomy 24:1-5; Proverbs 5:15-19; Malachi 2:14-16; Matthew 19:9; 1 Corinthians 7:3-5; Ephesians 5:25-33; Colossians 3:19; Hebrews 13:4; 1 Peter 3:7

Father: Genesis 17:12; Exodus 12:26-27; 13:8, 13-14; Leviticus 12:3; 18:21; 19:29; Numbers 18:15-16; 30:3-5; Deuteronomy 4:9; 6:6-7; 11:19; 21:15-17; Proverbs 13:24; 22:6; Ephesians 6:4; Colossians 3:21; 1 Timothy 5:8

Son: Exodus 20:12; 21:17; Leviticus 19:3; Ephesians 6:2

Purity: Exodus 20:14; Leviticus 18; 20; Matthew 5:27-28; Acts 15:20; 1 Corinthians 6:18

Food: Leviticus 3:17; 7:23-25; 11; 17:10-15; Exodus 23:19; Deuteronomy 12:16, 23; 14:2-21; Ephesians 5:18

Appearance: Leviticus 19:19, 27-28; Numbers 15:37-41; Deuteronomy 6:8-9; 11:20; 22:5, 11-12; 1 Corinthians 11:4, 14

Work and money: Exodus 20:9, 15; 22:25-27; Leviticus 6:1-5; 19:11, 13, 35-36; 25:35-37; Deuteronomy 15:1-11; 22:1-3, 8; 23:19-20; 24:6, 10-17; 25:13-16; Matthew 6:1-4; 22:21; Romans 13:7; 2 Corinthians 9:7; 2 Thessalonians 3:10

Neighbor: Exodus 20:13, 16; 22:22, 28; 23:1-8; Leviticus 19:14-18, 32-34; Numbers 30:2; Deuteronomy 10:19; 23:21-23; Matthew 5:21-22, 33-37; 1 Timothy 2:1-2; James 1:27

Yahshua and the apostles: Matthew 5:23-24, 44; 6:14-15; 18:21-35; 28:19-20; Mark 11:25; John 13:34; Acts 2:38; 1 Corinthians 11:23-26; 2 Corinthians 6:14; Ephesians 4:26-31; 1 Thessalonians 5:17; 1 Timothy 2:8; 3:1-7; Titus 1:5-9; Hebrews 10:25; 13:2; James 3:1; 4:6; 5:14; 1 Peter 5:2-6

Not applicable: Leviticus 1 to 7; 13 to 14; 19:9-10; 21 to 22; 25; 27:30-32; Numbers 5; 6; 19; Deuteronomy 14:22-29; 17; 25:4; 1 Corinthians 9:9

NOTES

Personal Notes and Convictions

Kingdom Life Ministry
Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance.

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.